

Japan Daily Brief

Friday, October 9, 2026

1,249 words · 5 min read

RE: Cyberattack wave · Consumption-tax bill submitted · Okinawa SOFA revision call · China title row · US-ROK hypersonic test

NIKKEI 225
69,030.92
▼ -1.31%

USD/JPY
158.27
▲ +0.34%

BRENT
\$103.09
▲ +2.76%

BOJ RATE
1.25%

• TOP STORIES

TECHNOLOGY

Japan declares cyber space emergency as attacks soar

Dozens of targets including car-rental operators, barbecue chains and rail group JR East have disclosed data leaks, prompting a government vigilance warning. Nikkei research tallied at least 320 million people exposed globally since September, with Bookoff and JR East each reporting roughly 6 million records leaked Friday.

FT

POLITICS-DIET

Government submits bill on food consumption tax reduction to parliament

Sanae Takaichi's government submitted a bill to reduce the consumption tax on food and nonalcoholic beverages from 8% to 1% starting in April, after cabinet approval earlier Friday. A restaurant-industry survey found *about 60 percent* of eateries fear the cut will reduce customers.

THE JAPAN TIMES

ALLIANCE

Okinawa resolution calls for revision of U.S. forces pact after murder

The Okinawa Prefectural Assembly adopted a resolution calling for revision of the 1960 Status of Forces Agreement after a US Marine was accused of murdering a woman. Dozens protested in Tokyo over the case, which police say involved the suspect traveling roughly 18 km by taxi with the victim to Naha.

THE JAPAN TIMES

CHINA-JAPAN

LDP's Furuya says Takaichi called China's sanctions against him 'great honor'

LDP lawmaker **Keiji Furuya** said Takaichi called China's sanctions against him a 'great honor,' amid renewed friction ahead of November's APEC summit. Beijing rejected Tokyo's complaint over its dropping of Takaichi's prime-ministerial title, with its Foreign Ministry saying 'genuine respect lies in facing history.'

THE JAPAN TIMES

KOREA-JAPAN

South Korea test-launches hypersonic missile

South Korea test-fired its first domestically developed hypersonic missile, overseen by President Lee, per the presidency. South Korean and Japanese vice defense ministers separately met in Japan and reaffirmed close coordination against North Korean nuclear and missile threats.

NHK

INDO-PACIFIC

Japan protests Russia's extradition requests for ICC president Tomoko Akane and 8 other court staff

Japan lodged a protest after Russian prosecutors sought the extradition of ICC President **Tomoko Akane** and eight other court officials, calling the move 'regrettable.' Akane is a Japanese national; Russia separately requested the handover of nine ICC figures.

WASHINGTON POST

• STAT OF THE DAY

320m

people exposed in global cyberattacks since September

Nikkei research tallied data leaks affecting at least 320 million people since September, with Bookoff and JR East each disclosing roughly 6 million customer records on Friday.

Global cyberattacks leak data on at least 320m people since Sept.: Nikkei research

• JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

KANTEI/PM · CABINET · MOFA · MOD · METI · MOF · BOJ · DIET · FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2026

PM Watch: PM appeared today · 0 day(s) since last confirmed appearance — Takaichi's cabinet approved and submitted the food consumption-tax cut bill to the Diet, and she pledged to keep watching yen and inflation moves carefully.

金融庁 · FINANCIAL SERVICES AGENCY

Watchdog orders partial business suspension at Prudential Life Insurance

Japan's financial regulator ordered Prudential Life Insurance Co. to partially suspend operations over sales-staff misconduct; a report cited a hypercompetitive culture that bred the misconduct.

→ Mainichi ↗

DIET SESSIONS / LDP

DIET / OPPOSITION

Pressure mounts on Farm Minister Kazuo Yana over conduct claims

Farm Minister Kazuo Yana faced renewed pressure amid reporting he used coarse language and sought to steer budget allocations; opposition parties weighed a censure motion while Takaichi has declined to replace him. Ishin's leader said he would not support Yana but backed his retention.

PUBLIC SENTIMENT & APPROVAL POLLING

POLLSTER	APPROVE	DISAPPROVE
JNN · Oct 4, 2026	63%	33.9%
Asahi · Sep 28, 2026	51%	33%
ANN · Sep 23, 2026	58.3%	27.6%
Kyodo · Sep 23, 2026	53.4%	30.9%
Nikkei · Sep 5, 2026 · 34d ago	62%	33%
Yomiuri · Sep 19, 2026	59%	30%
FNN · Sep 15, 2026 · 24d ago	61.6%	32.2%
NHK · Sep 10, 2026 · 29d ago	52.8%	30.8%

Discourse: Pressure is mounting on Farm Minister Kazuo Yana over conduct allegations, with opposition parties weighing a censure motion while Takaichi declines to replace him.

Poll tracker: [Observing Japan approval-rating aggregator](#) →

BUSINESS & ECONOMY

MACRO · REUTERS

Japanese household spending falls for ninth straight month

Real household spending dropped 3.1% in August, extending a nine-month decline despite wage gains, per Reuters and Xinhua reporting on Cabinet data.

MACRO · REUTERS

Japan reboots DOGE-style spending review to fund Takaichi pledges

Tokyo revived its cost-cutting spending review to find funds for Takaichi's agenda, though an earlier such effort identified only about \$110 million in savings per Nikkei.

FINANCE · THE JAPAN TIMES

Japan IPO fundraising hits 14-year low amid deal drought

Japan's IPO fundraising fell to its lowest in 14 years amid regulatory changes and a dearth of AI-related listings, contrasting with a dealmaking boom across Asia.

FINANCE · THE JAPAN TIMES

Global banks expand Japan debt teams as bond issuance booms

Global banks are bolstering their Japan debt capital markets teams as a fundraising boom driven by M&A and AI capital spending lifts bond issuance.

MANUFACTURING · NIKKEI ASIA · TERUMO

Terumo takes \$610m hit after losing US plasma-device customer

Japan's Terumo booked a \$610 million charge after losing a US customer for its plasma device.

MACRO · NIKKEI ASIA

Tourist-spending windfall shrinks as Chinese visitors plunge

Japan's inbound tourism spending windfall is narrowing as the number of Chinese visitors falls sharply.

REGIONAL PRESSURE WATCH

Normal — 25 items

CHINA

Beijing rejected Tokyo's protest over China dropping Takaichi's prime-ministerial title, with its Foreign Ministry saying 'genuine respect lies in facing history'; a Chinese envoy also condemned Japan's 'remilitarization push' at the UN. The title dispute runs alongside unresolved demands that Takaichi resolve her Taiwan-related remarks ahead of November's APEC summit.

NORTH KOREA

No new North Korean launch reported today; South Korean and Japanese vice defense ministers met in Japan and reaffirmed coordination against DPRK nuclear and missile threats, and South Korea test-fired its first domestic hypersonic weapon.

RUSSIA

Japan protested Russia's request for the extradition of ICC President Tomoko Akane and eight other court officials, calling it 'regrettable'; a Russian Embassy vehicle was also involved in a traffic incident near the Foreign Ministry, leaving four slightly injured.

Senkaku / ECS: No new China Coast Guard or PLA activity near the Senkakus was reported in today's articles.

"genuine respect lies in facing history"

Chinese Foreign Ministry · Chinese expert rebukes Japan's claim of 'international protocol' over Takaichi reference

Bottom line: China's title-and-Taiwan pressure on Takaichi is intensifying ahead of APEC while the Senkakus stay quiet; watch whether a Xi-Takaichi bilateral materializes.

• U.S.-JAPAN RELATIONS

BASING · THE JAPAN TIMES

Tokyo protest over Okinawa Marine murder case escalates base-presence unease

Dozens protested in Tokyo after a US Marine was accused of killing a woman in Okinawa, the latest in a string of incidents fueling unease over the large US troop presence; the Okinawa assembly adopted a SOFA-revision resolution the same day.

• INDO-PACIFIC PARTNERS

SOUTHEAST ASIA · NIKKEI ASIA

Mitsubishi Materials taps Vietnam for tungsten as China alternative

Japan's Mitsubishi Materials is turning to Vietnam for tungsten supply to reduce dependence on China.

SOUTHEAST ASIA · NIKKEI ASIA

Vietnam offshore oil and gas draw Japan, US to South China Sea

Vietnam's offshore oil and gas prospects are drawing Japan, the US and Russia into South China Sea energy development.

SOUTHEAST ASIA · NIKKEI ASIA

Japan-led Asia decarbonization bloc pivots to oil stockpiling

A Japan-led Asian decarbonization bloc is shifting toward oil-stockpiling measures, with Saudi Arabia and the UAE joining the push to bolster Asian oil buffers.

• SOCIAL STATEMENTS



Mao Ning

Chinese Foreign Ministry Spokesperson · Global Times · Oct 9

"genuine respect lies in facing history"

Analyst: Beijing rejected Tokyo's protest over China dropping Takaichi's prime-ministerial title, amid friction ahead of November's APEC summit.

Source →

• UPCOMING

Oct
18

Yokohama mayoral election

Seven candidates are contesting the Yokohama mayoral race, with voting and counting set for October 18.

Nov
1

APEC summit (estimated)

Tokyo remains uncertain whether Xi Jinping will hold a bilateral with Takaichi at APEC amid the unresolved Taiwan-remarks dispute; exact dates per host.

Nov
3

Culture Day (文化の日)

The 1946 constitution was promulgated on this date.

Nov
6

BOJ Governor Ueda to speak at IMF event

The IMF has invited Bank of Japan Governor Kazuo Ueda to speak on November 6, amid signals of broadening inflation and rate-hike debate.

Apr
1

Food consumption-tax cut takes effect (planned)

If passed, the reduction of the food and nonalcoholic beverage consumption tax from 8% to 1% would start in April.

CSIS Japan Chair

JAPAN DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

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generated 7:08 AM ET

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